

Kris Fitzwater

FINANCE DIRECTOR

07891 806 369 • Krisfitzwater@hotmail.com • CIMA Qualified

PROFILE SUMMARY

Strategic Finance Director with 10+ years' experience driving high-growth retail, wholesale, and franchise businesses. Proven track record scaling operations from £9m to £60m+ revenue and expanding multi-site portfolios from 5 to 65+ locations across UK and Ireland. Commercially focused and CIMA-qualified, with deep expertise in FP&A, funding strategy, and operational transformation. Trusted advisor to CEOs and investors, with a strong record of securing multi-million-pound funding, improving cashflow performance, and delivering sustainable EBITDA growth.

KEY SKILLS

- Strategic Finance Leadership
- FP&A & Commercial Business Partnering
- Budgeting, Forecasting & Scenario Planning
- Cashflow & Working Capital Optimisation
- Financial Controls & Governance
- Cost Reduction & Operational Efficiency
- Team Leadership & Development
- Funding, Banking & Investor Relations
- Multi-Site Retail & Franchise Finance
- Leveraging AI and automation to enhance reporting, forecasting, and decision-making

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Scaled business from 5 → 65 stores, increasing revenue from £9m to £60m+, with forecast to exceed £100m.
- Secured £13.5m+ funding and increased working capital facilities from £1.3m to £12m+.
- Delivered £1.5m (33%) logistics cost reduction through warehouse transformation.
- Reduced store payroll costs by £800k annually via workforce optimisation.
- Built and embedded full FP&A function and KPI framework across all departments.
- Led AI-enabled finance transformation, improving reporting speed, accuracy, and decision-making.

LEADERSHIP

- Built and led finance team across accounting and FP&A.
- Developed structured development programs improving team capability and retention.

EXPERIENCE

Miniso UK

OCT 2021 — PRESENT

Finance Director (Apr 2025 — Present) · Head of Finance (Oct 2021 — Mar 2025)

Overview. Finance lead for a high-growth retail, wholesale, and franchise business scaling from £9m to £60m+ revenue and 65+ stores across the UK and Ireland. Key partner to CEO and executive team, driving expansion, securing funding, and building a scalable finance function to support rapid growth.

- Oversaw the partial takeover — including financial reports, analysis, and KPMG audit — resulting in the company now reporting on the Hong Kong and New York stock markets as a subsidiary.
- Implemented a new financial reporting system and Budget & Forecast system.
- Established financial controls across all business functions: inventory investments, capital investment, financial reconciliations (bank & balance sheet), departmental budgets, store cash reconciliations, and operational spend (salaries and general expenses).
- Instated in-house financial reporting, previously outsourced to external accountants.
- Enhanced focus on the 'Value Chain' across all operational and commercial functions.

- Developed and delivered an inter-departmental mentoring program to identify efficiency and continuous-improvement opportunities.
- Built a culture of continual improvement within finance: 18-month career development plans for all direct reports, internal shadowing, and a strong focus on efficiency discipline.
- Incorporated a new franchisee investment model, building a bespoke concept for each potential franchisee based on store size and location.
- Established consignment models to support franchisees with restricted cashflow.
- Implemented new AI software (Claude, Claude Cowork, Claude Code) to improve 'live' financial analysis for finance and non-finance stakeholders.

STRATEGIC & LEADERSHIP

- Partner with CEO and COO on short- and long-term objectives; establish and deliver financial strategies aligned with executive direction.
- Contribute to overall business strategy and decision-making; assess financial risk to the business.
- Represent finance on the executive committee, providing regular insight into financial health, cashflow and results.
- Primary contact for HSBC Relationship Manager; ensure financial performance meets bank KPIs within Term and Trade loan covenants.

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT, REPORTING, CONTROL & GOVERNANCE

- Oversee preparation and sign-off for all monthly and annual financial statements across Miniso UK companies.
- Maintain treasury controls and processes: supplier invoices, PAYE and NI, salaries, pensions, and commercial property expenses.
- Complete annual statutory audits, quarterly VAT returns, and all Companies House filings.
- Arrange USD Time Option Hedges.
- Liaise with external auditors, accountants and HMRC.
- Oversee distribution of weekly finance trade pack, monthly store scorecard deck, and monthly financial newsletter.

FINANCIAL PLANNING & ANALYSIS

- Drive short- and long-term budgets, followed by rolling forecasts over an 18-month horizon.
- Assess and sign off monthly budget and forecast results; track performance against strategic objectives.
- Oversee monthly forecast reviews, scenario planning, and cashflow risk analysis.
- Sign off monthly analysis, inventory analysis, cost analysis, pricing reports, and profit margin reviews.

PREVIOUS ROLES

Projects & Strategy FBP Finance Manager · AXA Health	NOV 2020 — OCT 2021
Finance Manager · AAR Corp	JUL 2019 — NOV 2020
Senior Management Accountant & Business Partner · SGN	DEC 2017 — JUL 2019
Wolverine Worldwide Europe	OCT 2011 — DEC 2017
Senior Finance Analyst · Hush Puppies	MAR 2016 — DEC 2017
Finance Planning Analyst · Saucony	AUG 2013 — MAR 2016
Demand & Inventory Planner · Caterpillar Footwear	OCT 2011 — JUL 2013
Earlier Roles	
European Demand Planner · Timberland	AUG 2009 — OCT 2011
Merchandise · World Duty Free	DEC 2004 — JUL 2009

PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- CIMA Qualified